

Sub 3:30 Marathon Plan

The exact 15-week program Coach Tyler used to run 3:27:32 at the Pittsburgh Marathon — an hour and 18 minutes faster than his previous year on the same course.

3:27

TYLER'S FINISH TIME

1:18

FASTER. SAME COURSE.

15

WEEK PROGRAM

8:00

TARGET PACE/MI

WHO THIS IS FOR

Built for athletes who compete with themselves.

This plan isn't for beginners. It's built for people who have already run a marathon and want to do it seriously — with a real program, real structure, and a real time goal.

If you've got a marathon base and you're ready to actually train for 3:30, this is the plan that gets you there. It got me to 3:27. Follow it, do the work, and the time will come.

— Base fitness required

You should be comfortable running 15–20 miles per week before starting. This is not a couch-to-marathon plan.

— Time commitment

5–6 days of training per week. Long runs peak at 20 miles. Strength work is built in — not optional.

— Equipment

Access to a gym for the strength days. A GPS watch is strongly recommended for pace work.

— Goal pace

Target finish time 3:25–3:35. Marathon Pace (MP) throughout this plan = 8:00/mile.

KEY BENCHMARKS

How you know the plan is working.

✓ **10 miles @ 8:00 feeling controlled**

If this feels hard you need more base. If it feels easy you're on track.

✓ **18 miles with last 6 at MP**

The most important long run in the plan. If you can hit this, race day is yours.

✓ **Hold 7:40 for 5–6 miles in a tempo run**

Threshold work that builds the engine for race pace to feel sustainable.

THE STRUCTURE

How the 15 weeks are built.

WEEKS 1–4

Base Building

Establish your weekly mileage, get comfortable with the pacing, and introduce strength work. Long runs 10–13 miles. Marathon Pace intervals begin.

WEEKS 5–8

Load & Development

Mileage climbs. Threshold and cruise interval work builds your aerobic engine. Long runs 15–17 miles with MP finish miles.

WEEKS 9–11

Peak Phase

Highest training load. Two 20-mile long runs. 10-mile marathon pace workout. Race day simulation built in.

WEEKS 12–13

Second Peak

Rebuild volume after a cutback. Final big long run. Confidence builder workouts.

WEEKS 14–15

Taper

Mileage drops significantly. Sharpening runs only. Legs freshen up. You're ready.

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Week 1

BASE BUILDING

MON Easy Run 4–5 miles PACE: 9:00–9:30	TUE Interval Run 2mi easy warmup 5x2 min @ 10k pace 2 min jog recovery 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 6–7 miles PACE: 8:45–9:00	THU MP Intervals 2mi easy 3x1 mile @ MP (8:00) 2–3 min jog rest 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 3 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 10 miles PACE: 8:45–9:15	SUN Recovery / Floater 1–3 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	--	---	---	--	--	---

STRENGTH DAYS · MON / WED / FRI (alternate with yoga sessions)

Full Body — Mon • Deadlift (4x5) • Hang Cleans • Pullups • DB Swings • 1 Arm Press • Pushups • Conditioning: DB Thrusters, Burpee Jumps	Lower Body — Wed • Back Squat (4x5) • BB RDLs • Split Squats • Single Leg RDLs • Calf Raise • Conditioning: Walking Lunge, Farmers Carry	Upper Body — Fri • DB Bench (4x5) • BB Rows • 1 Arm DB Row • Decline Pushups • ISO Curls • Tricep Pushdowns • Conditioning: Ski Erg / Row Machine
--	---	--

Yoga A (Mon/Wed): Hips, ankles, spine — 30–40 min

Yoga B (Thu): Hips, glutes, breathing — 30–40 min

Week 2

BASE BUILDING

MON Easy Run 4–5 miles PACE: 9:00–9:30	TUE Interval Run 2mi easy warmup 6x2 min @ 10k pace 2 min jog recovery 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 6–7 miles PACE: 8:45–9:00	THU MP Intervals 2mi easy 4x1 mile @ MP (8:00) 2–3 min jog rest 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 3 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 11 miles PACE: 8:45–9:15	SUN Recovery / Floater 1–3 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	--	---	---	--	--	---

STRENGTH DAYS · MON / WED / FRI (alternate with yoga sessions)

Full Body — Mon • Deadlift (4x5) • Hang Cleans • Pullups • DB Swings • 1 Arm Press • Pushups • Conditioning: DB Thrusters, Burpee Jumps	Lower Body — Wed • Back Squat (4x5) • BB RDLs • Split Squats • Single Leg RDLs • Calf Raise • Conditioning: Walking Lunge, Farmers Carry	Upper Body — Fri • DB Bench (4x5) • BB Rows • 1 Arm DB Row • Decline Pushups • ISO Curls • Tricep Pushdowns • Conditioning: Ski Erg / Row Machine
--	---	--

Yoga A (Mon/Wed): Hips, ankles, spine — 30–40 min

Yoga B (Thu): Hips, glutes, breathing — 30–40 min

Week 3

BASE BUILDING

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Easy Run 5–6 miles PACE: 9:00–9:30	Interval Run 2mi easy warmup 5x3 min @ 10k pace 2 min jog recovery 1–2mi cooldown	Mid-Distance Easy 7–8 miles PACE: 8:45–9:00	MP Intervals 2mi easy 2x2 miles @ MP (8:00) 2–3 min jog rest 1mi cooldown	Rest or Easy 3 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	Long Run 12 miles PACE: 8:45–9:15 Last 3 @ 8:00	Recovery / Floater 1–3 miles Optional: Full Body Strength

STRENGTH DAYS · MON / WED / FRI (alternate with yoga sessions)

Full Body — Mon • Deadlift (4x5) • Hang Cleans • Pullups • DB Swings • 1 Arm Press • Pushups • Conditioning: DB Thrusters, Burpee Jumps	Lower Body — Wed • Back Squat (4x5) • BB RDLs • Split Squats • Single Leg RDLs • Calf Raise • Conditioning: Walking Lunge, Farmers Carry	Upper Body — Fri • DB Bench (4x5) • BB Rows • 1 Arm DB Row • Decline Pushups • ISO Curls • Tricep Pushdowns • Conditioning: Ski Erg / Row Machine
Yoga A (Mon/Wed): Hips, ankles, spine — 30–40 min		Yoga B (Thu): Hips, glutes, breathing — 30–40 min

Week 4

BASE BUILDING

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Easy Run 5–6 miles PACE: 9:00–9:30	Interval Run 2mi easy warmup 6x3 min @ 10k pace 2 min jog recovery 1–2mi cooldown	Mid-Distance Easy 8–9 miles PACE: 8:45–9:00	MP Intervals 1mi easy 3x2 miles @ MP (8:00) 2–3 min jog rest 1mi cooldown	Rest or Easy 3 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	Long Run 13.1 miles PACE: 8:45–9:15 Last 3 @ 8:15–8:30	Recovery / Floater 1–3 miles Optional: Full Body Strength

STRENGTH DAYS · MON / WED / FRI (alternate with yoga sessions)

Full Body — Mon • Deadlift (4x5) • Hang Cleans • Pullups • DB Swings • 1 Arm Press • Pushups • Conditioning: DB Thrusters, Burpee Jumps	Lower Body — Wed • Back Squat (4x5) • BB RDLs • Split Squats • Single Leg RDLs • Calf Raise • Conditioning: Walking Lunge, Farmers Carry	Upper Body — Fri • DB Bench (4x5) • BB Rows • 1 Arm DB Row • Decline Pushups • ISO Curls • Tricep Pushdowns • Conditioning: Ski Erg / Row Machine
Yoga A (Mon/Wed): Hips, ankles, spine — 30–40 min		Yoga B (Thu): Hips, glutes, breathing — 30–40 min

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Week 5

LOAD PHASE

MON Easy Run 6 miles PACE: 9:00–9:30	TUE Threshold Run 2mi easy warmup 4x5 min @ 7:10–7:20 2 min jog recovery 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 8–9 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU MP Intervals 2mi easy 5 miles @ MP (8:00) 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 3 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 15 miles First 11 @ 8:50–9:20 Last 4 @ 8:20–8:30	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	---	---	---	--	--	---

Week 6

LOAD PHASE

MON Easy Run 6–7 miles PACE: 9:00–9:30	TUE Cruise Intervals 2mi easy warmup 3x10 min @ 7:15–7:25 2 min jog recovery 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 9–10 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU MP Development 2mi easy 6 miles @ MP (8:00) 1–2mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 3 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 16 miles First 12 @ 8:50–9:20 Last 4 @ 8:15–8:25	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	---	--	---	--	--	---

Week 7

LOAD PHASE

MON Easy Run 7 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	TUE Threshold Run 2mi easy warmup 4x8 min @ 7:00 2 min jog recovery 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 9–10 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU MP Workout 2mi easy 7 miles @ MP (8:00) 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 4–5 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 17 miles First 11 @ 8:50–9:20 Next 4 @ 8:15–8:25 Last 2 easy	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	--	--	---	--	---	---

Week 8

LOAD PHASE

MON Easy Run 7 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	TUE Tempo Run 2mi easy warmup 5 miles @ 7:10–7:20 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 10–11 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU MP Workout 2mi easy 8 miles @ MP (8:00) 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 4–5 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 18 miles First 12 @ 8:50–9:20 Next 4 @ 8:15–8:25 Last 2 easy	SUN Recovery / Floater 4–5 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	---	---	---	--	---	---

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Week 9 ■ KEY WEEK

PEAK PHASE

MON Easy Run 7 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	TUE Threshold Run 2mi easy warmup 3x12 min @ 7:00 2 min jog recovery 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 10 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU KEY WORKOUT 2mi easy 10 miles @ MP (8:00) 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 4 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT RACE DAY SIM 20 miles First 14 @ 8:50–9:20 LAST 6 @ MP Treat this like race day	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	---	--	--	--	---	---

Week 10 ■ CUTBACK

PEAK PHASE

MON Easy Run 6 miles PACE: 9:00–9:30	TUE Threshold Run 2mi easy warmup 4 miles @ 7:10–7:20 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 8–9 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU MP Workout 2mi easy 6 miles @ MP (8:00) 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 4 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 16 miles Steady @ 8:45–9:10	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	---	---	---	--	--	---

Week 11

SECOND PEAK

MON Easy Run 7 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	TUE Threshold Run 2mi easy warmup 4x10 min @ 7:00 2 min jog rest 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 10–11 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU MP Workout 2mi easy 8 miles @ MP (8:00) 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 4 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 18–20 miles PACE: 8:45–9:10	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	---	---	---	--	---	---

Week 12 ■ RACE SIM

SECOND PEAK

MON Easy Run 7 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	TUE Cruise Intervals 2mi easy warmup 2x3 miles @ MP 3 min jog recovery Cap effort @ 165 HR	WED Mid-Distance Easy 10 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU Steady Aerobic 8 miles PACE: 8:30–8:45	FRI Rest or Easy 4 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT RACE DAY SIM 20 miles First 14 @ 8:50–9:20 Next 4–5 @ MP Last 1–2 on feel Finish strong	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	--	--	---	--	--	---

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Week 13

TAPER BEGINS

MON Easy Run 6 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	TUE Threshold Run 2mi easy warmup 3 miles @ 7:05–7:15 1–2mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 8 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU MP Workout — Last Check In 2mi easy 5–6 miles @ MP (8:00) 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 4 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 12–14 miles PACE: 8:45–9:10	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles Optional: Full Body Strength
---	---	---	--	--	---	---

Week 14

TAPER

MON Easy Run 6 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	TUE Tempo Run 2mi easy warmup 3 miles @ 7:10 1mi cooldown	WED Mid-Distance Easy 5 miles PACE: 8:50–9:10	THU MP Workout 2mi easy 4 miles @ MP (8:00) 1mi cooldown	FRI Rest or Easy 4 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Long Run 3–5 miles 4–6 strides PACE: 8:45–9:05	SUN Recovery / Floater 3–4 miles
---	--	---	---	--	--	---

Week 15 · Apr 27 — RACE WEEK

RACE WEEK

MON Easy Run 5 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	TUE Tune Up 2mi easy 3x1 mile @ MP Cooldown	WED Easy Run 4–5 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	THU Easy Run 3–4 miles PACE: 8:50–9:20	FRI Rest or Shakeout 2–3 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SAT Rest or Shakeout 2–3 miles PACE: 9:30–10:00	SUN RACE DAY 26.2 miles PACE: 8:00/mi Stay calm. You're ready.
---	--	---	---	--	--	---

A NOTE FROM COACH TYLER

You built this. Not me.

I ran this plan through one of the worst winters I can remember — early mornings before work, strength sessions after long runs, 20-milers in the cold. I didn't feel ready. I never felt ready.

But the work was in the log. Every mile, every threshold run, every MP interval. And when I crossed the finish line in Pittsburgh at 3:27, I wasn't surprised. I was relieved.

That's what a real plan does. It removes the guesswork and replaces it with confidence. Trust the structure. Do the work. The time will come.

If you want to build this into a fully customized 1-on-1 program built around your life, your schedule, and your goals — that's exactly what The Athletic Rebuild is.

APPLY FOR 1-ON-1 COACHING → alwaysreddyathletics.com

Always Reddy Athletics · alwaysreddyathletics.com · [@alwaysreddyathletics](https://www.instagram.com/alwaysreddyathletics)